

KRISHNA KALAKONDA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Machine Learning Engineer with 3+ years of experience building, integrating, and optimizing ML/NLP/LLM systems across APIs, product workflows, and data applications. Skilled in Python, FastAPI, Flask, Docker, MLflow, DVC, AWS, Scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow, spaCy, RAG, and model evaluation. Strong end-to-end background from dataset preparation and experimentation to deployment, monitoring, API troubleshooting, and product impact in startup environments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

ML Engineering: Model training, feature pipelines, experimentation, model evaluation, deployment, monitoring, error analysis, reproducibility, latency optimization

AI / NLP: LLMs, RAG, prompt engineering, fine-tuning workflows, NLP, NER, speech embeddings, transcription, recommender systems, deep learning

Frameworks: Scikit-learn, XGBoost, spaCy, PyTorch, TensorFlow, FastAPI, Flask, Streamlit, React, REST APIs, WebSockets

MLOps: Docker, AWS, Git, MLflow, DVC, Hydra, Kubeflow, Jenkins, JupyterLab, Jira, DataDog, Mixpanel

Data Systems: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Neo4j, Cypher, SQL, data validation, database architecture, API integrations

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Illuminating Impact | Full-Stack Data Science Intern | Chicago, IL | Jan 2026 - Present

- Review and improve an existing production codebase for a case management platform, identifying integration defects and shipping targeted fixes.
- Design modular AI feature architecture with service boundaries for data ingestion, LLM orchestration, recommendations, and API integration.
- Convert ambiguous product workflows into implementable backend components while considering scalability, privacy, latency, and maintainability.

DePaul University | Research Assistant | Chicago, IL | Apr 2025 - Present

- Design the ML system architecture for a multilingual immigrant assistant combining ASR, translation, structured extraction, recommendation, and retrieval components.
- Identify datasets and evaluation strategies for fine-tuning and benchmarking LLM, speech, translation, and recommender modules.
- Specify interfaces between models, databases, and APIs to support modular experimentation and eventual production deployment.

DePaul University | Research Assistant | Chicago, IL | Mar 2025 - Present

- Develop reusable ML experimentation workflows for ADHD and gender prediction, including preprocessing, feature engineering, model comparison, and evaluation.
- Train and tune classification models including Logistic Regression, kNN, and XGBoost, balancing predictive performance with model interpretability.
- Prepare analysis-ready datasets and modeling artifacts for reproducible research collaboration with faculty and fellow research assistants.

App Virality Technologies Pvt Ltd (Outplay) | Associate Data Scientist | Hyderabad, India | Jun 2022 - May 2024

- Implemented spaCy NER pipelines for objection extraction and classification, achieving 95% accuracy on sales email objection categories.
- Integrated LLM-based generation workflows into product features, reducing sales sequence creation time by 90%+ while supporting dynamic placeholders and step-level regeneration.
- Collaborated with product, backend, frontend, and sales stakeholders to move AI features from requirements and dataset design through integration, deployment, monitoring, and iteration.

- Mentored engineers during onboarding, delivered KT sessions, and documented implementation decisions for maintainability in a fast-moving startup environment.

DePaul University | Graduate Student Assistant | Chicago, IL | Feb 2025 - Jun 2025

- Built database architecture for preprocessed farm data, improving data organization for analytics and downstream application workflows.
- Developed a React-based dashboard connected to curated farm datasets, enabling users to inspect and validate structured records.
- Collaborated with research teammates to define data quality checks and improve consistency across ingestion and analysis steps.

App Virality Technologies Pvt Ltd (Outplay) | Software Engineer Intern | Hyderabad, India | Jan 2022 - May 2022

- Researched AI model options, prepared datasets, implemented quality checks, and documented experiments for production sales-tool integration.
- Collaborated with senior engineers to understand API-driven product development, model integration, and maintainable project documentation.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Conversation Intelligence Platform | Speech embeddings, transcription, NER, regex, scoring

- Built modules to analyze sales calls by extracting transcripts, speakers, objections, action items, tone, and SDR performance metrics.
- Used speech embeddings for speaker recognition with 100% accuracy and extracted action items with 92% accuracy using NER and regex.

Objection Handling API | spaCy, NLP, NER, model evaluation

- Developed a production NER workflow to detect and categorize prospect objections in emails with 95% accuracy.
- Designed the API-facing model logic so sales reps could prioritize high-intent, objection-heavy, or blocked conversations.

Phishing Website Detection | Flask, HTML, Random Forest, kNN

- Created a classifier-backed web application to predict whether a URL is legitimate or phishing based on extracted URL features.
- Achieved 97% accuracy with Random Forest and 92% with kNN while exposing predictions through a Flask UI.

Data Science Pipeline Tool | Streamlit, model training, downloadable artifacts

- Built reusable preprocessing, visualization, model-training, and report-generation workflows for rapid experimentation.
- Designed the application so users could compare data states and export trained models with model reports.

Magic Mail and Sequence Generator | LLMs, MongoDB, prompt engineering

- Integrated LLM generation flows into sales workflows with dynamic placeholders, A/B variants, and step-level regeneration.

Zoom Meeting Assistant | React, Python, WebSockets, Zoom SDK

- Built Zoom application integration with Python REST APIs to record and live-stream scheduled meetings.

LEADERSHIP & RECOGNITION

- Recognized as Top Performer of the Month at Outplay for consistently delivering high-impact AI/product solutions.
- Mentored new team members through onboarding, technical documentation, and KT sessions; led student events and won University Table Tennis Championship.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

DePaul University | Chicago, IL | M.S. in Data Science | Sept 2024 - Aug 2026 | GPA: 3.93/4.0

Rajiv Gandhi University of Knowledge Technologies | Basar, India | B.Tech in Electronics and Communication Engineering | Aug 2018 - May 2022 | CGPA: 8.17/10

Certifications: Machine Learning with Python - Coursera | Neural Networks and Deep Learning - DeepLearning.AI